

Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra

An incremental leap

It's finally here! The iPhone killer or the Android king, as many call it. The Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra has launched with much hype around it. Let's take a detailed look at what the new Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra offers. Does the minor tweak in design make any difference?

BUILD AND DESIGN

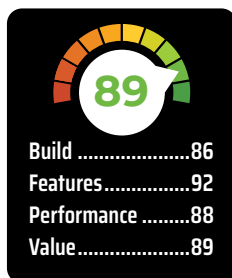
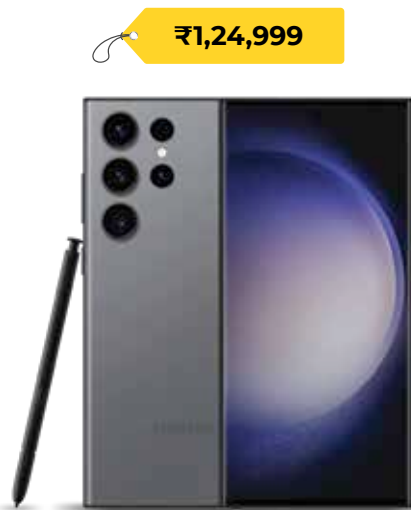
The Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra looks pretty much the same as its predecessor. The minor tweaks in the design, however, have made a very significant enhancement to the smartphone's overall in-hand feel and grip. The flatter sides now make it much easier to hold the S23 Ultra and the design now looks boxier. With the Galaxy S23 Ultra, Samsung has taken an Apple-like approach. Kept the fancy design that has worked well with minor tweaks. The flat edges make the grip much better than the predecessor, and the frame now feels more reinforced. Good and important tweaks to a design that didn't require any radical changes.

DISPLAY

The display is also similar to the previous generation. It comes with the latest LTPO 3.0 technology for an adaptive refresh rate. As expected from a Samsung flagship, it's beautiful. The colours are super accurate, it is super responsive, and bright enough to be used in all kinds of environments. We tested the display brightness using a Lux Meter, and the highest peak brightness we achieved was 1192 nits. Further, in our Calman test, it showed an average DeltaE of 2.4, which is very good.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the Samsung



Galaxy S23 Ultra comes with a custom Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 chip for Galaxy phones. This chip is paired with 12GB of RAM, and throughout our usage, the smartphone felt ultra fast and ultra slick. Coming to benchmarks, in Geekbench, the S23 Ultra left the competition behind. In 3D Mark, the Galaxy S23 Ultra scored 3781 points. In PC Mark, the S23 Ultra blew the competition out of the water. In Gamebench, the stability came out to be slightly lower than the best scores we have seen this year. We ran a CPU Throttling test, and it showed that the smartphone's CPU throttles to 86 percent, which is not too bad. In terms of heating, there were certain scenarios where the smartphone heated up. We also tested the heating with a Flir heat camera, and it showed that the phone heated up to a maximum temperature of 42.5-degree celsius, which is not too bad.

CAMERA

Coming to the camera, the images out of the primary 200-megapixel shooter are nothing short of super sharp and

detailed. This is as good as a camera gets for Android smartphones. It nicely manages colours and skin tones without losing any details or sharpness. Unleashing the full 200-megapixels yields much more detailed pictures, and the dynamic range is slightly better in low-light conditions. The images in 10X are superb. The details are clear and the images are sharp. In low lights also, the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra's camera works brilliantly. Coming to portraits, here also the phone's brilliant. The edge detection and background blur are superb, and the photos don't lose out on details or colours. The night portraits, look straight out of a DSLR. The camera does mess up in some rare conditions but give it a couple of tries, and you will get very good images out of this camera.

BATTERY LIFE

Coming to the battery, we get a 5,000mAh battery on the smartphone, along with 45W fast charging. During our usage, the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra gave us about 9 hours of on-screen time on one battery cycle. In terms of charging, the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra took a total of 84 minutes to charge from 0 to 100 per cent.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra is just an incremental update over its predecessor and a very good one at that. Samsung has focused on keeping the same recipe, but refining it for an overall better experience. board. The size, however, could still be too big for many users. Rest is all great!

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 for Galaxy | OS: Android 13, One UI 5.1 | Display: 6.8-inches Dynamic AMOLED 2x, 3088 x 1440 pixels | Refresh rate: Adaptive 120 Hz | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5 | ROM: 256 GB | Cameras (rear): 200 MP + 10 MP (telephoto) + 12 MP (ultrawide) + 10 MP | Selfie camera: 12 MP | Video: Up to 8K @30 fps | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | S-Pen Support: Yes | 5G: Yes

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